

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

POLICY COMMITTEE
RECOMMENDATION

FOR ENGROSSED

SENATE BILL NO. 1632

By: Alvord of the Senate

and

Hasenbeck of the House

POLICY COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

An Act relating to schools; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 14-135, which relates to career-readiness assessments; directing the State Department of Education, rather than the Oklahoma Department of Commerce, in certain cooperation to approve certain assessments and credentials; removing language making such approval subject to funding; directing the assessments to be made available to students in certain grades beginning in certain school year; directing the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education in certain consultation to promulgate certain rules; providing an effective date; and declaring an emergency.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 14-135, is amended to read as follows:

1 Section 14-135. ~~Subject to the availability of funds, beginning~~
2 ~~with the 2019-2020 school year, the Oklahoma Department of Commerce,~~
3 ~~in cooperation with the~~

4 A. The State Department of Education and, in cooperation with
5 the Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability, shall
6 review and approve career-readiness assessments and assessment-based
7 credentials that measure and document foundational workplace skills.
8 Beginning with the ~~2019-2020~~ 2026-2027 school year, the assessments
9 shall be made available to all public school districts to be
10 administered ~~to students~~ at the discretion of each school district's
11 administration to students in grades ten through twelve at least
12 once prior to their graduation from high school. The assessment-
13 based credential shall be available to any student who achieves the
14 prescribed level on the required ~~assessments~~ assessment. If the
15 public school district chooses to administer the assessments, the
16 assessments shall be administered at least once to each student who
17 chooses to take the assessment at no cost to the student. The
18 assessments shall:

19 1. Be a standardized, criterion-referenced measure of broadly
20 relevant foundational workplace skills;

21 2. Assess and document student readiness for a wide range of
22 jobs;

23 3. Measure skills in the following areas, including, but not
24 limited to:

- a. applied mathematics,
- b. workplace documents,
- c. graphic literacy, or
- d. critical thinking and leadership collaboration;

4. Align with research-based skill requirement profiles for specific industries and occupations;

5. Lead to nationally recognized work-readiness certificates or credentials for students who meet the minimum proficiency requirements on the component assessments; and

6. Be available in paper- and computer-based formats.

B. The Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education, in consultation with the American Council on Education National Guide, may promulgate rules to allow institutions of higher education within The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education to grant college credit based on assessment-based credentials and scores earned on career-readiness assessments.

SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

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